AI Image Generator

6. Prompt Language Reference

Version 1.0
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Platform: NVIDIA GeForce RTX 3090, Windows 11, Python 3.12

Stable Diffusion XL + Real-ESRGAN, served locally with Gradio, with per-image GPU telemetry recorded in SQLite.

6. Prompt Language Reference

Everything about a generation is expressed in the prompt. Matching is case-insensitive. Numeric directives are removed before the prompt reaches the model; descriptive words stay in because they also guide the image.

6.1 Size and shape

Write	Effect	Generated at
16:9	Widescreen	1344x768
9:16	Vertical widescreen	768x1344
4:3 / 3:4	Classic	1152x896 / 896x1152
3:2 / 2:3	Photo	1216x832 / 832x1216
1:1	Square	1024x1024
21:9 / 9:21	Ultrawide	1536x640 / 640x1536
5:4 / 4:5	Print	1088x896 / 896x1088
1920x1080 (any WxH)	Same ratio, scaled to about 1 megapixel; if larger than native, the output is upscaled and cropped to exactly that size	depends
portrait, tall, vertical, poster, book cover	2:3	832x1216
landscape, wide, horizontal	3:2	1216x832
square, icon, avatar, profile picture	1:1	1024x1024
wallpaper, desktop wallpaper, widescreen, banner, youtube thumbnail	16:9	1344x768
phone wallpaper, mobile wallpaper, instagram story, tiktok	9:16	768x1344
ultrawide, cinemascope	21:9	1536x640

Precedence: an explicit WxH beats an explicit ratio, which beats orientation words. Among orientation words the first match in the table order wins, so "portrait of a king, landscape" is tall.

6.2 Output resolution (upscaling)

Write	Long side after upscaling	Passes
2k	2560 px	1
4k or uhd	3840 px	1
8k	7680 px	2
3840x2160 (any size above native)	exactly that size, centre-cropped	1 or 2

Any of these also raises steps to 40 unless steps are given explicitly.

6.3 Quality and fidelity

Write	Effect
hd, ultra detailed, highly detailed, masterpiece, best quality, high quality	40 steps
quick, draft, fast, rough, preview	15 steps
25 steps, steps 25, steps=25	exactly that (1 to 100)
strict, exact, precise, literal	guidance 9 (follows the prompt closely)
creative, loose, dreamy, abstract, surreal	guidance 5 (more freedom)
cfg 8, guidance 8	exactly that (1 to 20)

Default is 30 steps and guidance 7.

6.4 Style presets

The first matching style adds descriptors that are not already present.

Write	Descriptors added
photorealistic, photo, photograph, dslr	photorealistic, 8k, DSLR photo, sharp focus, natural lighting
anime, manga	anime style, vibrant colors, clean lines, studio quality
cinematic, film still, movie scene	cinematic lighting, dramatic, film still, depth of field, color graded
watercolor	watercolor painting, soft edges, paper texture, pastel tones
oil painting, oil on canvas	oil painting, visible brush strokes, canvas texture, classical
3d render, 3d, octane, blender, unreal	3d render, octane render, volumetric lighting, highly detailed
pixel art, 8-bit, 16-bit	pixel art, retro game sprite, crisp pixels
digital art, concept art, digital painting	digital painting, concept art, trending on artstation, highly detailed
sketch, pencil sketch, line art, ink drawing	pencil sketch, line art, monochrome, hand drawn
comic, cartoon	comic book style, bold outlines, flat colors, halftone
cyberpunk	cyberpunk, neon lights, rain, futuristic city, high contrast
low poly	low poly, geometric, isometric, minimal shading

Note that the photorealistic preset contains the word "8k" as a quality descriptor; it does not trigger 8K upscaling because upscale words are detected on the original prompt before the suffix is added.

6.5 Batch and reproducibility

Write	Effect
3 images, 4 variations, 2 versions, x4	1 to 4 images, seeds N, N+1, N+2 ...
seed 42, seed: 42, seed=42	fixed seed; omitted means random

6.6 Worked examples

Prompt	Interpreted as
a cozy cabin in a snowy forest, 16:9, 4k	1344x768, upscale to 3840x2194, 40 steps, guidance 7
portrait of a cyberpunk samurai, 3 images, seed 42	832x1216, 30 steps, style cyberpunk, 3 images, seeds 42 to 44
desktop wallpaper of a mountain lake, photorealistic, 8k	1344x768, upscale to 7680x4389, 40 steps, style photorealistic
a cat, 1920x1080, quick	1344x768, upscale and crop to 1920x1080, 15 steps
oil painting of a ship in a storm 21:9 steps 45 cfg 8	1536x640, 45 steps, guidance 8, style oil painting
square icon of a fox, 2k	1024x1024, upscale to 2560x2560, 40 steps